

Ascend

January 6, 2026

901 NORTH GLEBE ROAD, 5TH FLOOR
ARLINGTON, VA 22203

Senior Product Engineer

Dear Hiring Manager,

I'm excited about the Senior Product Engineer role at Ascend. The opportunity to build AI-powered products from scratch for an engaged user base, with modern tools and no tech debt, is exactly what I'm looking for.

I've spent the last few years building greenfield products that ship fast and deliver real impact. I architected Canada's first pay-as-you-go insurance product that now generates \$4.3M annually and won a 2024 Guidewire Innovation Award. We went from initial design to production in 6 months. I also built a self-service infrastructure platform that reduced environment provisioning from weeks to hours, unblocking multiple teams and enabling rapid iteration.

While my direct LLM experience is limited, I've built backend services that ran ML algorithms at a medical AI company, and I'm genuinely excited about the latest AI tooling. I use AI-powered coding assistants daily and believe strongly in building guardrails that let teams move fast without sacrificing security or quality. The challenge of building evaluation frameworks and human-in-the-loop workflows for LLM products is something I want to learn and contribute to.

What draws me to Ascend is the combination of building from scratch, working with enthusiastic users, and using technology to transform a legacy industry. I've worked primarily in insurance for the last few years and see similar opportunities in accounting for technology to reshape operations and cost structures. Building products that enable intelligent automation is compelling work.

I work primarily in Python and TypeScript on AWS, building microservices and infrastructure. I've led small teams, collaborated with non-technical stakeholders, and built systems that serve multiple teams. I'm comfortable with ambiguity and ship iteratively based on user feedback.

I'd be happy to talk more about how I can contribute to Ascend's mission.

Sincerely,

Tyler Kuipers

Attached: Resume